

Juan Manuel Lozano Niño

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Profile

Economist and professional in Government and Public Affairs from Universidad de los Andes currently pursuing an M.A. in Economics (PEG), with experience in academic research on projects related to economics of crime, security and criminal justice policy, macroeconomics and labor economics. Recognized for fast learning, organization, proactivity, teamwork, relationship building and leadership. Experience in applied causal inference, large-scale Colombian administrative data, spatial analysis and econometric modeling in STATA, R and Python, with three co-authored working papers.

Education

Universidad de los Andes, M.A. in Economics (PEG) Aug 2026 – Present

Relevant Courses: Advanced Econometrics, Advanced Game Theory, Big Data and Machine Learning, Behavioral Economics.

Universidad de los Andes, B.A. in Economics Aug 2022 – May 2026

Relevant Courses: Crime Economics, Macroeconomics from the Central Bank, Monetary Policy Theory.

Universidad de los Andes, B.A. in Government and Public Affairs Aug 2022 – May 2026

Relevant Coursework: Introduction to Public Management, The Politics of Public Policy, Public Policy Analysis, Qualitative Methods.

Colegio San Carlos, High School Diploma Aug 2010 – Jun 2022

Activities: Captain of the soccer team, elected student ombudsman (*personero*) and Model United Nations delegate.

Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant Aug 2026 – Present

Faculty of Economics - Universidad de los Andes

Teaching Assistant in Introduction to Macroeconomics (Prof. Marc Hofstetter) and Head Teaching Assistant in Macroeconomics III (Prof. Daniel Mejía). In charge of the weekly complementary lecture, the design and grading of problem sets and exams, and the administration of courses of up to 100 students.

Research Assistant Oct 2025 – Present

CEDE (Center for Studies on Economic Development) – Prof. Daniel Mejía

Applied research in the economics of crime and security: design and implementation of causal inference strategies and econometric modeling to evaluate the impact of public and private policies on urban crime, conspicuous consumption, illegal drug markets, the criminal justice system and criminal recidivism. Construction, validation and cleaning of large-scale administrative datasets; geospatial analysis in ArcGIS Pro applied to urban economics models; and theoretical and empirical modeling in STATA, Python and R. Also responsible for literature reviews, the drafting of academic papers, and support to the hiring committee of the Faculty of Economics.

CEDE (Center for Studies on Economic Development) – Prof. Hernando Zuleta May 2026 – Present

Applied research on the labor market, official statistics and demographic change: construction and harmonization of microdata and administrative records (GEIH national household survey and PILA social security records), econometric estimation and assessment of the consistency of official indicators of formality, unemployment and labor force participation. Responsible for literature reviews, data processing and analysis in STATA and R, and the drafting of academic papers and policy notes.

Cornell Emerging Markets Institute – Prof. Lourdes Casanova and Anne Miroux Jun 2025 – Jul 2025

Member of the team that produced the 2025 Emerging Markets Annual Report, conducting the quantitative analysis and database management for the ranking of the 20 leading emerging economies and proposing a new methodology. Contributed to the creation of visualizations on foreign direct investment and to the writing of critical essays on economies that are key for emerging markets. [Emerging Markets Multinational Report \(2025\)](#)

Aug 2024 – Dec 2025

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant (Grader)

Universidad de los Andes:

Econometrics I (Prof. Camila Galindo); **Macroeconomics II** (Prof. Fernando Jaramillo); **Probability and Statistics** (Prof. Alex Bueno); **Integral Calculus and Probability** (Prof. David Riveros); **Political Ideas** (Prof. Mauricio Velásquez).

Comprehensive support to teaching through the design and grading of academic activities for groups of up to 129 students. Led conceptual review sessions and taught complementary classes on applied statistical analysis using STATA.

Publications and Working Papers

- Mejía, D. and Lozano, J. (2026). Impuestos al cigarrillo, contrabando, recaudo fiscal e ingresos del crimen organizado [Cigarette taxes, smuggling, tax revenue and organized crime income]. **CEDE Working Paper #18**. [Available here](#)
- Zuleta, H., Lozano, J., López-Urbe, M. and Angarita, G. (2026). Cambio demográfico y mercado laboral en Colombia: cohortes entrantes, crecimiento económico y desafíos de política [Demographic change and the labor market in Colombia: entering cohorts, economic growth and policy challenges]. **Macro Note #72** [Available here](#)
- Zuleta H., Lozano J. (2026). Empleo formal en Colombia, 2023–2026: rezago de reporte, ponderación poblacional y la controversia GEIH-PILA. [Formal employment in Colombia, 2023–2026: reporting lag, population weighting, and the GEIH-PILA controversy.] (In publication)

Presentations

- *Impuestos al cigarrillo, contrabando, recaudo fiscal e ingresos del crimen organizado* [Cigarette taxes, smuggling, tax revenue and organized crime income] (with Daniel Mejía). Presentation of the study's results at an event convened by Philip Morris International, which brought together national media, customs police authorities, think tanks and departmental finance secretaries. Bogotá, April 13, 2026. Media coverage in [La República](#).
- Participant in the labor market workshops of ANIF (Colombian Association of Financial Institutions): three discussion sessions (July – September 2026) with researchers from Banco de la República (Central Bank of Colombia), ANIF and Pontificia Universidad Javeriana on the quality and consistency of Colombian labor statistics, with emphasis on formality and informality, unemployment and labor force participation indicators.
- *Empleo formal en Colombia, 2023–2026: rezago de reporte, ponderación poblacional y la controversia GEIH-PILA* (with Hernando Zuleta). Economic Policy Seminar, Banco de la República (Central Bank of Colombia). Bogotá, September 23, 2026. (Scheduled date)

Honors and Awards

Academic Scholarship Recipient

May 2022

Excellence Scholarship awarded by the employees' cooperative of Banco de la República (Central Bank of Colombia).
Top score on the national standardized high school exam (ICFES).

Projects

Board of Directors Member - CEDE Jr. Seminar and Brown Bag Seminar (Uniandes)

Aug 2026 - Present

Member of the organizing committee of the research seminars of the Graduate School of the Faculty of Economics. Responsible for coordinating the program's research initiatives and for convening and scheduling the sessions in which students present recent work and discuss academic progress.

Co-Director and Member, Macroeconomics Research Group - Faculty of Economics (Uniandes)

Jan 2025 - Dec 2025

Led the student research group on current, theoretical and computational macroeconomics. Production of Student Macro Notes on: 1) Latin American central banks' reliance on the Phillips Curve, 2) pension reforms and 3) fiscal rule design. Launch of the podcast "[Al Margen](#)" featuring leading Colombian macroeconomists.

Member, Impact Evaluation Research Group - Faculty of Economics (Uniandes)

Jan 2025 - May 2025

Production of a Student Reader evaluating the impact of the main digital wallets on the financial independence and inclusion of Colombian households.

Member, Research Group - Center for Security and Drug Studies (CESED)

Aug 2023 - Dec 2023

Visit to La Picota prison to analyze human rights dynamics inside penitentiary facilities.

Skills

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (IELTS 7.5/9), French (B1), Greek (A2)

Programming: Excel, STATA, R, ArcGIS Pro, $\LaTeX$, Python, MATLAB.

Quantitative methods: Applied causal inference (RCTs, IV, RD, DiD, TWFE, event studies, synthetic control, Bartik instruments, local projections) and machine learning (web scraping, decision trees, bagging, random forest, boosting and XGBoost, single- and multi-layer neural networks (backpropagation, dropout and batch normalization) and spatial cross-validation).